## CONCEPT OF DEVELOPMENT

Since the end of the Second World War, the dominant understanding of development was akin to the concept of economic growth within the context of a free market international economy. It was believed that only economic growth was a panacea for poverty. Therefore, measurement of economic growth in terms of Gross Domestic Product per capita, industrialization and agriculture came to be acknowledged as criteria for categorizing countries on the scale of development. Likewise, World Bank reports reflected categorization of countries as low-income, lower middle-income, upper middle-income, or high-income countries.

This perception of development, as synonymous with economic growth, took firm root in the aftermath of the Second World War. In post-War years, the reconstruction of the war-torn economies of the developed world, especially of Europe, became a priority. The course of the reconstruction process was, however, guided by the Cold War calculations and it saw huge transfer of money from the United States to Europe in the form of bilateral aid through the Marshall Plan of 1947. Harry S. Truman, the 33rd President of the United States, gave meaning to the concept of development and also adopted it as a goal of state policy. It is generally accepted that Truman's Point Four Program, launched on 10 January 1949, endowed the term 'development' with a special meaning in the sense that development was linked with economic growth (in the war torn Europe) which in turn was linked with the growth of liberal international economic order and containment of communism. Therefore, post-War international order exhibits an attempt by the West to create a stable international order through the United Nations and its affiliates, such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF) the World Bank and GATT. These affiliates were supposed to provide the institutional bases of a liberal international economic order. Simultaneously, around this time, there was a wave of decolonization and numerous countries emerged on the political scenario. They were ascribed as 'Third World' countries and now the focus shifted towards them. The international organizations and agencies as well as the United States and the West now tried to